

How to Read a Study Record | ClinicalTrials.gov

Learn how to read and understand a study record on ClinicalTrials.gov.

Overview

The study record includes these main parts:

- Study introduction: At the top of the study record, this area provides the title of the study, administrative information about the study, and whether or not the study is looking for participants.
- Study Details tab: This tab is organized into sections by the type of information and provides details about how the study works and the people involved.
- Researcher View tab: This tab provides information about the study organized in a way that works best for data researchers and journal editors.
- Results tab: This tab provides the results of the study, if they are available.
- Record History tab: This tab shows a table of any changes made to the study record over time.

On a desktop or laptop computer, several of the tabs include a left-sided menu that allows you to move to a specific section.

On a mobile device, you'll see each section as you scroll through a study record. A menu bar will appear on the top of the screen titled, "On this page" that will allow you to move from one section to another.

Helpful features

Feature	Function
	Click this to see the glossary definition for the term.
	Click this to see more information in part of the study record.
	Click this to see less information in part of the study record.
	Click Expand all content to view all information on the page.
	Click Collapse all content to view less information on the page.
	Click Expand all to view all information in a section.
	Click Collapse all to view less information in a section.
	Click this to open the glossary.

The Study introduction area

In this area you'll find information that applies to the entire study record.

- Study status – whether the study is currently looking for or not looking for participants
 - Green box - the study is looking for participants or soon will be
 - Red box - the study is not looking for participants
 - Brown box - the study status is unknown
- Brief title of the study – a short title that describes what the study is about
- ClinicalTrials.gov ID (NCT number) – the ID number assigned to this study when it was registered on ClinicalTrials.gov
- Study sponsor - the organization or person who has control over the study
- Information provided by – the person or organization responsible for entering the study information, also called the Responsible Party
- Last Update Posted - the date the last changes to the study record were posted on the ClinicalTrials.gov website

The Study Details tab

This tab contains information about the people involved in the study, how it will be conducted, and information about participation.

There are 8 possible parts:

- Study Overview
- Contacts and Locations
- Participation Criteria
- Study Plan
- Collaborators and Investigators
- Publications (if these are available)
- Study Record Dates
- More Information

To move to a section, click on the title in the menu to the left.

Study Overview

This section tells you what the study is about, important study dates, and other administrative details.

On the left side of this section, the information you might find includes:

- Brief Summary and Detailed Description - the purpose of the study
- Official Title - the title given to the study by the researchers, often written in scientific language
- Conditions - the focus of the study, usually a disease, illness, or condition, but may also be another health-related issue
- Intervention/Treatment - the treatment, device, or procedure that's being studied
- Other Study ID Numbers - other identifying numbers for the study

On the right side of this section, you'll find:

- Study Dates - the study start dates and completion dates, some of these may be estimated dates
- Enrollment - the number of participants who joined a study or the number researchers hope will join the study
- Study Type

- Interventional (also called clinical trials) – studies in which participants are assigned to receive an intervention so that researchers can study the effects
- Observational (including patient registries) – studies in which participants are not assigned to receive an intervention and are observed over time for health-related outcomes
- Expanded access – studies that allow patients with serious conditions to receive a drug or treatment outside of a clinical trial
 - If Expanded Access is available, the Expanded Access Type will also appear on the right side of the Study Overview
- Phase - the stage of the study, based on definitions from the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA)

Note that the study records for each type of study will have different types of information available.

At the bottom of the Study Overview section are resource links provided by the National Library of Medicine to learn more about topics related to the study.

Contacts and Locations

This section provides information on who to contact with questions about participating in the study and the locations where the study is taking place. If available, the study contact information can be found under the Study Contact or under a specific location, listed as Contact.

Contacts

- Study Contact or Location Contact - the name and contact information for someone who can answer questions about joining the study, the types of participants the study is looking for, and what happens during the study
- Study Contact or Location Contact backup - the name and contact information for someone you can reach if you can't reach the main Study Contact or the location contact (not always shown)

Important points about study contact information:

- Information for contacting a study is only available for a study that is open for participants.
 - For an Interventional or Observational study, contact information is listed for a study that is "Not yet recruiting" or "Recruiting." Note that a study that is "Not yet recruiting" may not have contact information.
 - For an Expanded Access study, contact information is listed if the Study Status is "Available."
- No contact information is listed for a study with a Study Status that is "Active, not recruiting," "Completed," "Terminated," "Enrolling by invitation," "Suspended," or "Withdrawn."
- For studies that have an "Unknown" Study Status, contact information may or may not be shown, depending on the last known status of the study. If a Study Contact is listed, the contact information may not be up to date.

Study Map and Locations

This section shows a map and locations where the study is taking place listed in alphabetical order. In the United States, locations will be listed alphabetically by state and then city. A location name may be listed but an address will not be.

Click the map to see these features:

- Red pins - Show specific study locations, also called clinical sites
 - Click on a red pin to zoom to that location information in the list.
- Blue circles - Show areas with many study locations
 - Click on a blue circle to zoom the map in to show more detail.

If you click on a location in the list, the map will zoom in to show that location. If you searched for a study using the location filter on the home page by entering an address or place, the map will already be zoomed in to that address or place, with a circle representing the search distance and the study locations within it. You can zoom in on the map by double clicking or using your cursor. Hold down the "Ctrl" button on your keyboard and use your mouse wheel to scroll up to zoom in and scroll down to zoom out.

Contacts and Locations

This section provides contact details for people who can answer questions about joining this study, and information on where this study is taking place.

To learn more, please see the [Contacts and Locations section in How to Read a Study Record](#).

Study Contact 1

Name: [REDACTED]

Phone Number: [REDACTED]

Email: [REDACTED]

Study Contact Backup

Name: [REDACTED]

Phone Number: [REDACTED]

Email: [REDACTED]

This study has 5 locations

United States

Maryland Locations

 Bethesda, Maryland, United States, 20892

Recruiting

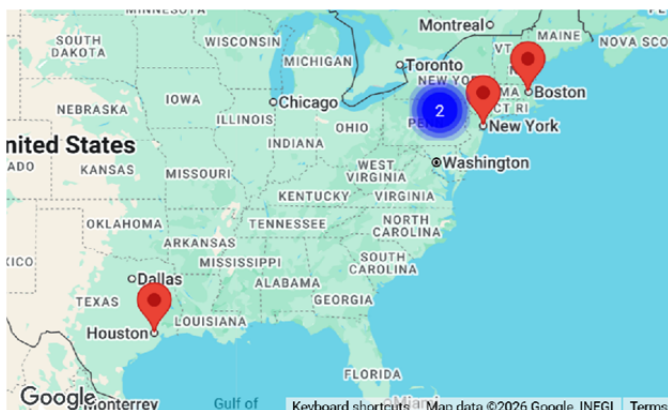
National Institutes of Health Clinical Center

Contact: [REDACTED]

Massachusetts Locations

 Boston, Massachusetts, United States, 02115

Not yet recruiting



Screenshot of the Contacts and Locations section showing the locations map.

Participation Criteria

Also known as Eligibility Criteria, this section gives details about the types of participants that the study researchers need for the study.

Most records will show the Participation Criteria as:

- Inclusion Criteria - the characteristics of people who can join the study
- Exclusion Criteria - the characteristics of people who cannot join the study

On the right side of the participation criteria, you will find:

- Ages Eligible for Study - the ages of people who can join the study
- Sexes Eligible for Study - the biological sex of people who can join the study
- Accepts Healthy Volunteers - tells if the study accepts participants who are healthy

Study Plan

This section describes how the study is set up and what the study is measuring. Click on the + or - to open or close each of these parts:

- How is the study designed?
- What is the study measuring?

How is the study designed?

The information found here describes how the study is set up and run. Each type of study has slightly different information and the lists below do not include all the possible types of information you might find here.

- Interventional study (clinical trial):
 - Design Details
 - Primary Purpose - what is being studied, such as a test (diagnostic) or a treatment
 - Allocation - how participants are assigned to a treatment or control
 - Interventional Model and Interventional Model Description - the way the researchers assign interventions to participants in a clinical study
 - Masking - a procedure used in a study to keep participants unaware of what group they are in and what treatment they are receiving
 - Arms and Interventions table - a table that shows what intervention each arm of the study will receive
- Observational study:
 - Design Details
 - Observational Model - the way participants are identified and followed during an observational study
 - Time Perspective - whether the researchers will collect data during the study or will use data that has already been collected
 - Biospecimen Retention and Biospecimen Description - the type of sample that will be collected and stored from study participants, such as a blood sample or skin sample (not all studies will have this information)
 - Groups and Interventions - describes the characteristics of the group or groups in the study

What is the study measuring?

This part often has a table format to explain:

- Primary Outcome Measures - the most important measures to learn the effects of the drug, device, or intervention, including how and when researchers will measure it
- Secondary Outcome Measures - these measures are still of interest, but less important than the primary measures
- Other Pre-specified Outcome Measures - any other measures that are part of the study

For an Expanded Access study, the Study Plan section is replaced with a section called Interventions, which includes information about the intervention or treatment being used in the study.

Collaborators and Investigators

These are the names of people and organizations carrying out the study.

Publications

This is where you will find papers in scientific journals that are related to the study, if there are any. If no publications are available, this section won't be shown.

Study Record Dates

These are administrative dates for the study, such as when the organization or person who has control over the study submitted the study to ClinicalTrials.gov.

More Information

Additional information about the study, which may include:

- Terms related to this study - keywords related to the health conditions and interventions in the study
- Plan for Individual Participant Data (IPD) - a description of whether individual participant data will be shared, when it will be shared, and how it will be protected
- Drug and device information, study documents, and helpful links - shows if the study intervention is a U.S. FDA-regulated drug or device and may also have links to study documents and websites with more information about the study

There is also a link here to the Record History.

The Researcher View tab

This section contains a more detailed description of the study details tab, organized in a way that is useful to data researchers and journal editors.

The Results tab

This section contains the results of the study, if available. To learn more about the information found in the Results tab, see [How to Read Study Results](https://clinicaltrials.gov/study-basics/how-to-read-study-results)(https://clinicaltrials.gov/study-basics/how-to-read-study-results).

The Record History tab

This section shows the history of changes to the study record. You can use this tab to see different versions of the study record and compare the changes made to the study record over time. This tab is most often used by data researchers.

